Pradeep Penugonda

Secondary Science Teacher | VCE Biology

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VIT 727895 (provisional registration) | Australian Permanent Resident | Working with Children Check: current

PROFILE

Science teacher with a postgraduate biology research background: Master of Science in Biotechnology and Bioinformatics (High Distinction), Master of Science in Microbiology and three peer-reviewed publications. Full-time at St Francis Xavier College since 2023, teaching seven Years 7 to 9 classes across two campuses, with three years of VCE Biology tutoring at Units 1 to 4. Seeking an ongoing Science role that includes a first school-based VCE Biology allocation.

Teaching areas: Biology, Years 10 to 12 (VCE Units 1 to 4) | Science, Years 7 to 10 | STEM, Years 7 to 10 | Chemistry, Years 7 to 10

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

St Francis Xavier College, Berwick and Officer campuses January 2023 to present
Secondary Science Teacher, Years 7 to 9

- Teach seven Science classes across Years 7, 8 and 9 (full-time load) on two campuses, with units planned to Victorian Curriculum 2.0 following STAVCON 2025 training.
- Ran a Year 7 cycle of inquiry (class of 28, six on Personalised Learning Plans): the class median on the Separation Techniques unit test rose from 51% at diagnostic to 70%, and students scoring 80% or above rose from 0 to 11 of 28, measured against three instruments including a formal lab report on the shared faculty rubric.
- Build Standard and Personalised Learning Plan versions of assessments and practicals, used across both campuses, and pre-teach subject vocabulary for EAL learners.
- Introduced dissection practicals at Year 7, a first for the campus, and designed a pluck (respiratory and digestive) dissection shared across both campuses with full instructions; a Year 7 water-rocket investigation I designed was adopted by a colleague's STEM class.
- Authored and submitted proposals for two 2027 electives: Biomedical Science, and Motion, Energy and Materials.
- Run a voluntary lunchtime Science support service, approved by the Head of Education and open to any student in the College; students from other teachers' classes book sessions. Design custom animations and digital resources for every unit.

Private VCE Biology Tutor (self-employed) 2023 to present

- One-to-one tuition in Units 1 to 4: course content, SAC preparation, exam technique and revision resources.

Teaching placements, 55 days supervised practice 2019 and 2022

- Mullauna College, 2022 (40 days), Year 9 Science: designed and delivered a four-week student-led research unit. East Preston Islamic College, 2019 (15 days), Years 7 to 9 Science.

Eurofins, Melbourne: Laboratory Assistant (internship) 2021

- Microbiology quality control under Good Laboratory Practice.

EDUCATION

- **Master of Teaching (Secondary Education)**, Victoria University, Melbourne, 2023. Specialisation: Years 7 to 10 Science
- **Master of Science (Biotechnology and Bioinformatics)**, La Trobe University, Melbourne, 2017. High Distinction
- **Master of Science (Microbiology)**, Bangalore University, India, 2013
- **Bachelor of Science (Microbiology)**, Osmania University, India, 2010

REGISTRATION AND PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

- Victorian Institute of Teaching: registration 727895, provisional. Full-registration evidence complete; recommendation panel at the end of Term 4 2026.
- Accreditation to Teach in a Catholic School: in progress, 23 of 25 hours complete (Diocese of Sale).

- LANTITE satisfied (embedded in the Victorian initial teacher education program).
- Professional learning: STAVCON 2025 (Victorian Curriculum 2.0 Science); Bill Rogers Behaviour Management series, applied in practice; peer observation cycle on higher-order questioning.
- Child safety and wellbeing training, current: Mandatory Reporting, PROTECT, Child Safe Standards, NCCD, Disability Standards for Education, Anaphylaxis, CPR.

PUBLICATIONS

Three peer-reviewed publications in microbiology and mycology (International Journal of Pharma and Bio Sciences; Academic Journal of Cancer Research), 2013 to 2014. Full citations on request.

REFEREES

- **Rosalie Harding**, Pedagogical Coach, St Peter's College (former mentor and supervisor, St Francis Xavier College). 0434 578 465, rharding@stpeters.vic.edu.au
- **Melinda Davison**, Teacher, Doveton College (former Professional Practice Leader, St Francis Xavier College). 0468 357 576, melinda.davison@education.vic.gov.au